CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

GLAZIER (GLASS) IN THE AI ERA

Buildings are turning into glass boxes, and every pane is cut, carried and set by human hands.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K median for a precision trade you can enter in 6–12 months with a credential on the way. The catch: heavy, sharp, fragile material that punishes one careless grip.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

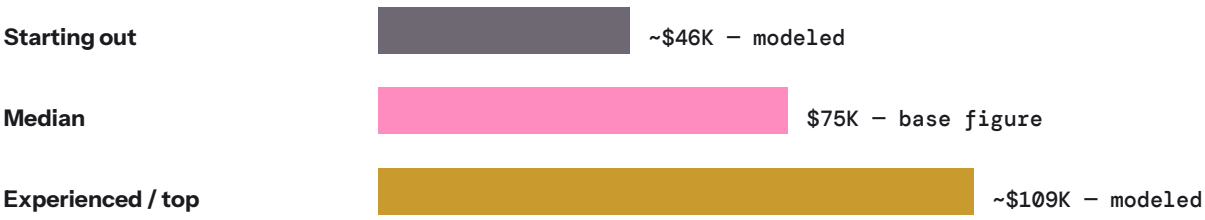
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Why it works: storefronts, shower enclosures, mirrors, railings, curtain walls — glass is in everything new.
- Where it bites: one slip can mean a ruined panel, a bad cut, or both.
- The AI angle: AI can measure a room from scans and price the panel; it cannot carry it up the stairs and set it true.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Glazier (glass) is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A GLAZIER (GLASS) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Measure openings precisely and cut or order glass to fit

- ✓ Install windows, storefronts, shower doors, mirrors and railings
- ✓ Seal, level and anchor panels so they stay put and stay watertight
- ✓ Replace broken glass in homes, shops and office buildings

Think: a carpenter whose lumber is transparent, fragile and shows every fingerprint.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Digital measuring, CNC cutting and automated ordering have eaten the workshop errors. Design software lays out storefront systems before anyone picks up a panel.	Site work stays human: real openings are never square, access is never easy, and a two-person carry of a huge lite still needs judgment, grip and nerve.

⚠ **Glass is unforgiving in both directions — measure wrong and the panel is scrap; handle wrong and it is a trip to urgent care.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Clean, precise work compared to most trades ✓ Mix of shop time and site time ✓ Finished work looks genuinely impressive	✗ Heavy panels in awkward stairwells and lifts ✗ Cuts and strains are the trade's tax ✗ Perfectionist tolerances — 'close enough' leaks

Good fit? You are precise, patient and strong, with a measurer's instinct for checking twice.
Bad fit? You rush, estimate measurements by eye, or hate work where one mistake costs the whole piece.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — GLASS SHOP HELPER	DOOR B — APPRENTICESHIP / TRAINING PROGRAM
Local glass shops hire helpers to cut, carry and install under experienced glaziers. You learn measuring discipline and handling in the shop, then graduate to site installs — the classic route in.	Union and contractor programs train glaziers for commercial work — curtain walls, storefronts, big systems — with a recognized credential at the end. Slower start, bigger buildings.

Smart move: Specialize in showers and custom residential glass. Homeowners pay well for frameless work, and it is steadier than chasing commercial bids.
Where you land after: Journeyman glazier, commercial crew lead, or your own residential glass and shower company.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN GLASS	GET INTO	MEASURE LIKE	SITE INSTALLS	EARN THE	RUN YOUR

STEP 1 — Learn glass basics

FREE · WEEKS 1-2

- Glass types, thicknesses, safety glass rules and hardware
- How to read a tape to a sixteenth without guessing

STEP 2 — Get into a shop

PAID · MONTH 1

- Apply as a helper in residential or commercial glass shops
- Shop time first: cutting, edging, handling, suction cups

STEP 3 — Measure like a glazier

ON THE JOB · MONTHS 2-4

- Learn deductions, squareness checks and templating
- A wrong measure costs the panel — this is the core skill

STEP 4 — Site installs

SUPERVISED · MONTHS 3-6

- Windows, mirrors and shower doors with a lead glazier
- Sealing and leveling until water and light agree with you

STEP 5 — Earn the credential

MONTHS 6-12

- Complete your program or employer credential requirements
- Add storefront or curtain wall systems if going commercial

STEP 6 — Run your own installs

MONTH 12

- Measure, order and install standard jobs solo
- Build the reputation: on time, no breakage, clean silicone

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: learn glass types and find glass shops and apprenticeship intakes nearby.
- Days 1–30: start as a helper; master handling, cutting and shop safety.
- Days 31–60: practice measuring real openings and making templates.
- Days 61–90: assist on site installs — showers, mirrors, replacements.

□ Day 90: solid helper turning glazier — the credential path runs 6–12 months, and you are on it.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **MEASURE TWICE. CARRY ONCE.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.